



MATH155: Polynomial and Rational Functions

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Learning Objectives

- Solve quadratic equations by factoring and the quadratic formula
- Find the vertex of a parabola in standard form
- Identify excluded values from the domain of a rational function
- Determine horizontal and vertical asymptotes of rational functions

Simplify each expression completely. Show all steps and circle your final answer.

Solving quadratic equations

1. Solve the quadratic equation: $1x^2 + 1x + -20 = 0$.

$$x^2 + 1x - 20 = 0$$

Answer: _____

2. Solve the quadratic equation: $2x^2 + 12x + 10 = 0$.

$$2x^2 + 12x + 10 = 0$$

Answer: _____

3. Solve the quadratic equation: $2x^2 + 16x + 24 = 0$.

$$2x^2 + 16x + 24 = 0$$

Answer: _____

4. Solve the quadratic equation: $1x^2 + 7x + 6 = 0$.

$$x^2 + 7x + 6 = 0$$

Answer: _____

5. Solve the quadratic equation: $1x^2 + 1x + -12 = 0$.

$$x^2 + 1x - 12 = 0$$

Answer: _____

6. Solve the quadratic equation: $2x^2 + 20x + 50 = 0$.

$$2x^2 + 20x + 50 = 0$$

Answer: _____

Quadratic formula — discriminant

7. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 + 2x - 15 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 + 2x - 15 = 0$$

Answer: _____

8. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 - 2x - 3 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 2x - 3 = 0$$

Answer: _____

9. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 - 1x - 2 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 1x - 2 = 0$$

Answer: _____

10. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 + -1x + -2 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 1x - 2 = 0$$

Answer: _____

11. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 + -2x + -8 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 2x - 8 = 0$$

Answer: _____

12. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 + -3x + -10 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 3x - 10 = 0$$

Answer: _____

Vertex of a parabola

13. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = -3x^2 + 18x - 33$.

$$f(x) = -3x^2 + 18x - 33$$

Answer: _____

14. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = 2x^2 + -4x + -4$.

$$f(x) = 2x^2 - 4x - 4$$

Answer: _____

15. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = 2x^2 + -12x + 18$.

$$f(x) = 2x^2 - 12x + 18$$

Answer: _____

16. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = 1x^2 + -10x + 30$.

$$f(x) = 1x^2 - 10x + 30$$

Answer: _____

17. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = -1x^2 + 10x + -22$.

$$f(x) = -1x^2 + 10x - 22$$

Answer: _____

18. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = 1x^2 + 6x + 2$.

$$f(x) = 1x^2 + 6x + 2$$

Answer: _____

Domain of a rational function

19. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (3x + 1) / (4x + -1)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{3x + 1}{4x + -1}$$

Answer: _____

20. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 2 / (x - 4)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{2}{x - 4}$$

Answer: _____

21. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (4x + -1) / (3x + -2)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{4x + -1}{3x + -2}$$

Answer: _____

22. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 4 / (x - 8)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{4}{x - 8}$$

Answer: _____

23. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (1x + -2) / (2x + 0)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{1x + -2}{2x + 0}$$

Answer: _____

24. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 9 / (x - -8)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{9}{x - -8}$$

Answer: _____

25. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (3x + -1) / (5x + -5)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{3x + -1}{5x + -5}$$

Answer: _____

26. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 8 / (x - -3)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{8}{x - -3}$$

Answer: _____

27. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (4x + -1) / (3x + 7)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{4x + -1}{3x + 7}$$

Answer: _____

28. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 2 / (x - 1)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{2}{x - 1}$$

Answer: _____

29. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (1x + -1) / (4x + 5)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{1x + -1}{4x + 5}$$

Answer: _____

30. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 6 / (x - 8)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{6}{x - 8}$$

Answer: _____



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ANSWER KEY & SOLUTIONS

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Topics: Solving quadratic equations, Quadratic formula — discriminant, Domain of a rational function, Vertex of a parabola. All answers verified by independent computation.

Solutions

Solving quadratic equations

1. Solve the quadratic equation: $1x^2 + 1x + -20 = 0$.

$$x^2 + 1x - 20 = 0$$

→ The equation factors as $1(x - (4))(x - (-5)) = 0$.

→ Set each factor to zero: $x - (4) = 0$ or $x - (-5) = 0$.

→ Solutions: $x = -5$ and $x = 4$.

Answer: $x = -5$ or $x = 4$

2. Solve the quadratic equation: $2x^2 + 12x + 10 = 0$.

$$2x^2 + 12x + 10 = 0$$

→ The equation factors as $2(x - (-1))(x - (-5)) = 0$.

→ Set each factor to zero: $x - (-1) = 0$ or $x - (-5) = 0$.

→ Solutions: $x = -5$ and $x = -1$.

Answer: $x = -5$ or $x = -1$

3. Solve the quadratic equation: $2x^2 + 16x + 24 = 0$.

$$2x^2 + 16x + 24 = 0$$

→ The equation factors as $2(x - (-2))(x - (-6)) = 0$.

→ Set each factor to zero: $x - (-2) = 0$ or $x - (-6) = 0$.

→ Solutions: $x = -6$ and $x = -2$.

Answer: $x = -6$ or $x = -2$

4. Solve the quadratic equation: $1x^2 + 7x + 6 = 0$.

$$x^2 + 7x + 6 = 0$$

→ The equation factors as $1(x - (-6))(x - (-1)) = 0$.

→ Set each factor to zero: $x - (-6) = 0$ or $x - (-1) = 0$.

→ Solutions: $x = -6$ and $x = -1$.

Answer: $x = -6$ or $x = -1$

5. Solve the quadratic equation: $1x^2 + 1x + -12 = 0$.

$$x^2 + 1x - 12 = 0$$

→ The equation factors as $1(x - (3))(x - (-4)) = 0$.

→ Set each factor to zero: $x - (3) = 0$ or $x - (-4) = 0$.

→ Solutions: $x = -4$ and $x = 3$.

Answer: $x = -4$ or $x = 3$

6. Solve the quadratic equation: $2x^2 + 20x + 50 = 0$.

$$2x^2 + 20x + 50 = 0$$

→ The equation factors as $2(x - (-5))(x - (-5)) = 0$.

→ Set each factor to zero: $x - (-5) = 0$ or $x - (-5) = 0$.

→ Solutions: $x = -5$ and $x = -5$.

Answer: $x = -5$ or $x = -5$

Quadratic formula — discriminant

7. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 + 2x - 15 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 + 2x - 15 = 0$$

→ Identify: $a = 1$, $b = 2$, $c = -15$.

→ Discriminant: $b^2 - 4ac = (2)^2 - 4(1)(-15) = 64$.

→ $x = (-2 \pm \sqrt{64}) / 2 = (-2 \pm 8) / 2$.

→ $x = -5$ or $x = 3$.

Answer: $x = -5$ or $x = 3$

8. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 - 2x - 3 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 2x - 3 = 0$$

→ Identify: $a = 1$, $b = -2$, $c = -3$.

→ Discriminant: $b^2 - 4ac = (-2)^2 - 4(1)(-3) = 16$.

→ $x = (2 \pm \sqrt{16}) / 2 = (2 \pm 4) / 2$.

→ $x = -1$ or $x = 3$.

Answer: $x = -1$ or $x = 3$

9. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 - 1x - 2 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 1x - 2 = 0$$

→ Identify: $a = 1$, $b = -1$, $c = -2$.

→ Discriminant: $b^2 - 4ac = (-1)^2 - 4(1)(-2) = 9$.

→ $x = (1 \pm \sqrt{9}) / 2 = (1 \pm 3) / 2$.

→ $x = -1$ or $x = 2$.

Answer: $x = -1$ or $x = 2$

10. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 + -1x + -2 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 1x - 2 = 0$$

→ Identify: $a = 1$, $b = -1$, $c = -2$.

→ Discriminant: $b^2 - 4ac = (-1)^2 - 4(1)(-2) = 9$.

→ $x = (1 \pm \sqrt{9}) / 2 = (1 \pm 3) / 2$.

→ $x = -1$ or $x = 2$.

Answer: $x = -1$ or $x = 2$

11. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 + -2x + -8 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 2x - 8 = 0$$

→ Identify: $a = 1$, $b = -2$, $c = -8$.

→ Discriminant: $b^2 - 4ac = (-2)^2 - 4(1)(-8) = 36$.

→ $x = (2 \pm \sqrt{36}) / 2 = (2 \pm 6) / 2$.

→ $x = -2$ or $x = 4$.

Answer: $x = -2$ or $x = 4$

12. Use the quadratic formula to solve $x^2 + -3x + -10 = 0$ ($a = 1$, roots are integers).

$$x^2 - 3x - 10 = 0$$

→ Identify: $a = 1$, $b = -3$, $c = -10$.

→ Discriminant: $b^2 - 4ac = (-3)^2 - 4(1)(-10) = 49$.

→ $x = (-3 \pm \sqrt{49}) / 2 = (3 \pm 7) / 2$.

→ $x = -2$ or $x = 5$.

Answer: $x = -2$ or $x = 5$

Vertex of a parabola

13. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = -3x^2 + 18x + -33$.

$$f(x) = -3x^2 + 18x - 33$$

→ Use the vertex formula $h = -b / (2a)$ with $a = -3$, $b = 18$.

$$\rightarrow h = -(18) / (2 * -3) = 3.$$

$$\rightarrow k = f(3) = -3(3)^2 + 18(3) + -33 = -6.$$

→ Vertex: (3, -6).

Answer: Vertex = (3, -6)

14. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = 2x^2 + -4x + -4$.

$$f(x) = 2x^2 - 4x - 4$$

→ Use the vertex formula $h = -b / (2a)$ with $a = 2$, $b = -4$.

$$\rightarrow h = -(-4) / (2 * 2) = 1.$$

$$\rightarrow k = f(1) = 2(1)^2 + -4(1) + -4 = -6.$$

→ Vertex: (1, -6).

Answer: Vertex = (1, -6)

15. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = 2x^2 + -12x + 18$.

$$f(x) = 2x^2 - 12x + 18$$

→ Use the vertex formula $h = -b / (2a)$ with $a = 2$, $b = -12$.

$$\rightarrow h = -(-12) / (2 * 2) = 3.$$

$$\rightarrow k = f(3) = 2(3)^2 + -12(3) + 18 = 0.$$

→ Vertex: (3, 0).

Answer: Vertex = (3, 0)

16. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = 1x^2 + -10x + 30$.

$$f(x) = 1x^2 - 10x + 30$$

→ Use the vertex formula $h = -b / (2a)$ with $a = 1$, $b = -10$.

$$\rightarrow h = -(-10) / (2 * 1) = 5.$$

$$\rightarrow k = f(5) = 1(5)^2 + -10(5) + 30 = 5.$$

→ Vertex: (5, 5).

Answer: Vertex = (5, 5)

17. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = -1x^2 + 10x + -22$.

$$f(x) = -1x^2 + 10x - 22$$

→ Use the vertex formula $h = -b / (2a)$ with $a = -1$, $b = 10$.

$$\rightarrow h = -(10) / (2 * -1) = 5.$$

$$\rightarrow k = f(5) = -1(5)^2 + 10(5) + -22 = 3.$$

→ Vertex: (5, 3).

Answer: Vertex = (5, 3)

18. Find the vertex of the parabola $f(x) = 1x^2 + 6x + 2$.

$$f(x) = 1x^2 + 6x + 2$$

→ Use the vertex formula $h = -b / (2a)$ with $a = 1$, $b = 6$.

$$\rightarrow h = -(6) / (2 * 1) = -3.$$

$$\rightarrow k = f(-3) = 1(-3)^2 + 6(-3) + 2 = -7.$$

→ Vertex: $(-3, -7)$.

Answer: Vertex = $(-3, -7)$

Domain of a rational function

19. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (3x + 1) / (4x + -1)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{3x + 1}{4x + -1}$$

→ Set the denominator equal to zero: $4x + -1 = 0$.

→ Solve: $4x = -1$, so $x = 1/4$.

→ The domain is all real numbers except $x = 1/4$.

Answer: $x \neq 1/4$

20. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 2 / (x - 4)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{2}{x - 4}$$

→ The denominator is $x - 4$. Set it equal to zero: $x - 4 = 0$.

→ Solve: $x = 4$.

→ Domain: all real numbers except $x = 4$.

Answer: $x \neq 4$

21. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (4x + -1) / (3x + -2)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{4x + -1}{3x + -2}$$

→ Set the denominator equal to zero: $3x + -2 = 0$.

→ Solve: $3x = -2$, so $x = 2/3$.

→ The domain is all real numbers except $x = 2/3$.

Answer: $x \neq 2/3$

22. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 4 / (x - 8)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{4}{x - 8}$$

→ The denominator is $x - 8$. Set it equal to zero: $x - 8 = 0$.

→ Solve: $x = 8$.

→ Domain: all real numbers except $x = 8$.

Answer: $x \neq 8$

23. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (1x + -2) / (2x + 0)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{1x + -2}{2x + 0}$$

→ Set the denominator equal to zero: $2x + 0 = 0$.

→ Solve: $2x = -0$, so $x = 0$.

→ The domain is all real numbers except $x = 0$.

Answer: $x \neq 0$

24. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 9 / (x - -8)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{9}{x - -8}$$

→ The denominator is $x - -8$. Set it equal to zero: $x - -8 = 0$.

→ Solve: $x = -8$.

→ Domain: all real numbers except $x = -8$.

Answer: $x \neq -8$

25. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (3x + -1) / (5x + -5)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{3x + -1}{5x + -5}$$

→ Set the denominator equal to zero: $5x + -5 = 0$.

→ Solve: $5x = -5$, so $x = 1$.

→ The domain is all real numbers except $x = 1$.

Answer: $x \neq 1$

26. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 8 / (x - -3)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{8}{x - -3}$$

→ The denominator is $x - -3$. Set it equal to zero: $x - -3 = 0$.

→ Solve: $x = -3$.

→ Domain: all real numbers except $x = -3$.

Answer: $x \neq -3$

27. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (4x + -1) / (3x + 7)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{4x + -1}{3x + 7}$$

→ Set the denominator equal to zero: $3x + 7 = 0$.

→ Solve: $3x = -7$, so $x = -7/3$.

→ The domain is all real numbers except $x = -7/3$.

Answer: $x \neq -7/3$

28. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 2 / (x - 1)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{2}{x - 1}$$

→ The denominator is $x - 1$. Set it equal to zero: $x - 1 = 0$.

→ Solve: $x = 1$.

→ Domain: all real numbers except $x = 1$.

Answer: $x \neq 1$

29. Find the value(s) excluded from the domain of $f(x) = (1x + -1) / (4x + 5)$.

$$f(x) = \frac{1x + -1}{4x + 5}$$

→ Set the denominator equal to zero: $4x + 5 = 0$.

→ Solve: $4x = -5$, so $x = -5/4$.

→ The domain is all real numbers except $x = -5/4$.

Answer: $x \neq -5/4$

30. Find the excluded value from the domain of $g(x) = 6 / (x - 8)$.

$$g(x) = \frac{6}{x - 8}$$

→ The denominator is $x - 8$. Set it equal to zero: $x - 8 = 0$.

→ Solve: $x = 8$.

→ Domain: all real numbers except $x = 8$.

Answer: $x \neq 8$
